Project Management Framework Guide

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I manage software projects using a structured, PMI-based methodology, strengthened by real-world experience delivering software solutions.

Rather than applying a one-size-fits-all approach, I adapt my process to fit the unique needs, scale, and team dynamics of each project to ensure efficiency and successful delivery.

1. My Approach

I manage software projects using a structured methodology based on **PMI (Project Management Institute)** best practices combined with **Agile execution**.

This ensures:

- Clear scope definition
- Controlled execution
- Transparent communication
- Predictable delivery

My role is to **plan, coordinate, and ensure successful delivery, not** just manage tasks.

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2. Engagement Model

Step 1: Initial Discovery (Free)

- One discovery meeting
- Understand business goals and requirements
- Identify high-level scope

Step 2: Initial Proposal

- High-level outline of:
  - Client needs
  - Assumptions
  - Initial scope

Step 3: Scope Definition Phase (Paid)

Before full execution, we start with a **dedicated scope definition phase** to ensure clarity and alignment.

3. Project Flow (Simplified)

Discovery → Scope Definition → Design → Time Estimation & Cost Finalization → Development → Deployment → Closing

4. Phase 1: Scope Definition & Planning

Overview

This phase is a structured discovery and planning engagement designed to transform initial ideas into a **clear, actionable, and approved project blueprint**.

It ensures alignment, reduces risks, and creates a solid foundation for accurate design and development execution.

Duration

Typically completed within **5 working days**, depending on scope complexity and client responsiveness.

Objectives

- Align on business goals and product vision
- Clearly define project scope and boundaries
- Break down work into structured components
- Prepare a reliable foundation for design and estimation

Activities

- In-depth requirements gathering sessions
- Business and user flow definition
- Product scope finalization
- Work Breakdown Structure (WBS) creation
- Feature prioritization (MVP vs future phases)
- Assumptions and constraints documentation

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Deliverables

- ☑ Scope Definition Document (Signed)
- ☑ Detailed Feature List (Prioritized)
- ☑ Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)
- ☑ Assumptions & Constraints Log

Cost Structure

Project Management (PM): Fixed Price

This phase is offered at a **fixed cost**, derived from the estimated effort required to:

- Conduct meetings
- Document requirements
- Align stakeholders
- Review and finalize deliverables

Estimation Basis (Transparency Model)

The fixed price is calculated based on:

- Estimated working hours per day
- Number of working days
- Scope complexity
- Level of collaboration and iteration required

Illustrative Example

A typical engagement may involve:

- 2 hours/day × 5 days = 10 hours
- Based on the applicable hourly rate

Resulting in a **fixed phase cost defined upfront.**

Important Note

The final cost is confirmed **before** starting the phase and **may vary depending on project complexity and stakeholder involvement.**

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Payment Terms

- 50% upfront before starting the phase
- 50% upon delivery of the Scope Definition Document

Approval Gate

No design work begins until the Scope Definition Document is reviewed and formally approved.

Scope Control

Any requirements not documented and approved in this phase will be considered **out of scope** and handled through the change request process.

Very Important:

“This phase ensures that all future work is built on a clear, validated foundation: saving time, cost, and rework during design and development.”

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5. Phase 2: UI/UX Design

Activities:

- Low-fidelity wireframes
- High-fidelity UI/UX design
- Iterations based on feedback

Deliverables:

- ☑ Approved wireframes
- ☑ Final UI designs

Cost Structure for:
1) Project Management (PM)

- Fixed cost based on design coordination, reviews, and alignment
- Typically **~25% of the UI/UX designer's total effort**

2) UI/UX Design

- Based on detailed estimation by the UI/UX designer
- Depends on number of screens, complexity, and iterations

Payment Terms:

- 50% before starting
- 25% after low-fidelity approval
- 25% after high-fidelity approval

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6. Phase 3: Estimation & Cost Finalization

> After design approval, a **critical planning step** is performed before development.
>
> I don't lock development costs until design is approved, because that's the only way to give you an accurate and fair estimate.

Purpose:

- Translate designs into technical scope
- Accurately estimate development effort
- Define final cost and timeline

Activities:

- Technical breakdown
- Effort estimation (for developers)
- Timeline planning

Deliverables:

- Development Plan
- Final Timeline
- **Final Cost Breakdown**

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Cost Structure:

Type	Cost
PM Cost	Planning & estimation effort
Development Cost	Fully calculated
Deployment Cost	Estimated
Closing Cost	Estimated

Outcome:

A **final fixed project cost** is defined based on real data.

Rule:

No development starts before full approval.

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7. Phase 3: Development & Execution

Activities:

- Sprint planning & execution
- Task tracking (tools like: Jira, Clickup, …..)
- Daily follow-ups with team
- Risk & issue management
- Team coordination
- Progress reporting

Deliverables:

- ☑ Incremental feature delivery
- ☑ Progress reports
- ☑ Client-validated features

Cost Structure:

Type	Cost
PM Cost	Execution + Monitoring
Development Cost	Based on approved estimate

Payment:

- Milestone-based (per feature delivery)

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8. Phase 4: Deployment & Production

Activities:

- Final testing coordination
- Go-live support

Deliverables:

- ☑ Live product
- ☑ Deployment documentation

Payment:

- Final milestone payment

9. Phase 5: Project Closing

Activities:

- Final handover
- Documentation delivery
- Retrospective

Deliverables:

- ☑ Final report
- ☑ Lessons learned

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11. Change Request Policy

To maintain control and efficiency:

Included:

- Up to **2 minor revisions per phase**

Not Included:

- New features
- Major changes

Change Request Process:

1. Submit request
2. Impact analysis (time & cost)
3. Client approval
4. Implementation

Rule:

> No change is implemented without full approval.

12. Scope Protection

Any work not explicitly defined in the approved scope document is considered **out of scope**.

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13. Client Responsibilities

To ensure smooth execution:

- Provide feedback within **24 hours**
- Assign a **single point of contact**
- Approve deliverables on time
- Provide clear requirements

14. Timeline Dependency

All timelines depend on client responsiveness and approval speed.

Delays in feedback may result in:

- Timeline shifts
- Resource rescheduling

15. Communication & Reporting

- Weekly progress reports
- Regular meetings (agreed upfront)
- Transparent tracking

16. Agreement

By proceeding with the project, both parties agree to:

- Defined scope
- Payment structure
- Delivery model
- Change request process

17. Sign-Off

Client Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

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